

Subject Description Form

Subject Code	COMP3531
Subject Title	IT Entrepreneurship
Credit Value	3
Level	3
Pre-requisite / Co-requisite / Exclusion	
Objectives	The subject aims at equipping students with the latest knowledge and skills to: 1. understand basic elements of starting a new business in information technology; 2. prepare a business plan; 3. arrange financial support, accounting and legal requirements; and 4. plan entry and exit strategies.
Intended Learning Outcomes	Upon completion of the subject, students will be able to: <u>Professional/academic knowledge and skills</u> (a) understand why entrepreneurship is an important business strategy in information technology; (b) become familiar of the entrepreneurship process and know different entrepreneurial skills; (c) understand how to develop a business plan and make informed decisions when they see opportunities to start an IT company; (d) understand the components of managing the operations, laws, accounting, finance and marketing of running an IT company; (e) formulate strategies for entry and exit of the IT business; <u>Attributes for all-roundedness</u> (f) select setting up a company when there is an opportunity and run it to success or join such a company when there is a reasonable chance that it succeeds later using entrepreneurial skills; (g) gather information independently to write and present business plans to seek investors; and (h) learn to solve complex problems and contribute to group work.

Subject Synopsis/ Indicative Syllabus	Topic
	1. Introduction to IT Entrepreneurship Introduction to entrepreneurship; reasons for engineering, science, and humanities (i.e. non-MBA) students to study entrepreneurship.
	2. Unfair Advantage High-tech start-up; entrepreneurial experience; tools; techniques.
	3. Business Plan 1: From Idea to Opportunity Entrepreneurial opportunity; identification of major risks in each of these categories: technology, market, team, and financial; customer development.
	4. Entrepreneurial Marketing and Sales Difficulties of marketing in a start-up; product development and sales functions; discontinuous innovation; disruptive technology; market segmentation, targeting and positioning.
	5. Business Models and Legal Essentials Intellectual property (IP): patents, copyrights, trade secrets and trademarks; government regulation; industries requirements; other legal matters.
	6. Business Plan 2: Introduction to Venture Resources Business plan; risks; fund raising; venture capitalists; structure of a typical venture capital firm.
	7. Financings Staged financings; high potential opportunity; factors in considering when deciding on the proposed venture capital deal.
	8. Social Entrepreneurship Social entrepreneurship different from the other kinds of entrepreneurship; types of social entrepreneurship; social venture vs. for-profit start-up.
	9. Stock Options Equity shares; ownership; cost of the stock options; compensation; motivation.
	10. Guest Lectures Entrepreneur / finance issues; venture capitalists; IT management; marketing / technology issues.
	Tutorials:
	Topic
	1. Accounting and Case Method Workshop 2. Building the Start-up Team 3. Business Plan 4. Venture Finance Workshop

Teaching/ Learning Methodology	This subject consists mainly of class lectures and tutorials. For the class lectures, various cases will be presented to help students understand why entrepreneurship is an important business strategy in information technology. Students will be given time to participate in discussions when the cases are presented. During tutorial sessions, students will be given chances to discuss case studies, brainstorm business plans and presenting materials. Students are expected to develop creative thinking and critical thinking by brainstorming the ideas and judging other students’ ideas.									
Assessment Methods in Alignment with Intended Learning Outcomes	Specific assessment methods/tasks	% weighting	Intended subject learning outcomes to be assessed							
			a	b	c	d	e	f	g	h
	Continuous Assessment	30%								
	Assignments and / or Project		✓	✓	✓	✓	✓	✓	✓	✓
	Examination	70%	✓	✓		✓	✓			
	Total	100%								
	Explanation of the appropriateness of the assessment methods in assessing the intended learning outcomes: The assignments are either individual and / or project reflecting the contemporary opportunities and issues of entrepreneurship.									
Student Study Effort Expected	Class contact:									
	▪ Lecture							39 Hrs.		
	▪ Tutorial/Lab							0 Hrs.		
	Other student study effort:									
	▪ Assignments, Project, Exam							70 Hrs.		
	Total student study effort							109 Hrs.		
Reading List and References	Reference Books: 1. Kuratko, Donald D., <i>Entrepreneurship: Theory, Process, and Practice</i>, 11th Edition, Cengage, 2020. 2. Mollick, Ethan, <i>Entrepreneurship Simulation: The Startup Game</i>, Harvard Business Review.									

	3. Halt Jr., G.B., Donch Jr., J.C., Stiles, A.R. and Fesnak, R., <i>Intellectual Property in Consumer Electronics, Software and Technology Startups</i>, Springer, 2014. 4. Ideabook, by GoVenture (http://www.goventure.net/products/AboutIdeabook.aspx)
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